

LOOP — UI Design Rules

Agents for Humans Hackathon · Everyday Agents track

0. Purpose of This Document

This is the visual and verbal design system for LOOP's UI — the dashboard, approval view, and activity timeline described in the Agent Build Brief. It plays the same role that the synQdash design rules play for that product: a single reference so every screen looks like it belongs to the same product, built by the same hand, with the same values. It is deliberately specific to LOOP and does not reuse synQdash's palette or layout model — the two products make different promises to different users, and should not look like siblings.

1. Brand Rationale

synQdash is a dark, premium operations console for agencies running many clients at once — the visual language of a control room. LOOP is the opposite kind of product: a single person's quiet personal agent, dealing in receipts, warranties, and bills — real paperwork, real trust, real money. The UI should feel like a well-run personal filing system, not a dashboard you have to operate. That is the reasoning behind every choice below: a light, paper-toned surface instead of a dark console; a deep, quiet green instead of a loud accent; evidence shown in a document-like way instead of buried in generic cards.

The green is deliberately not a bright "success" or "eco" green — those read as generic and, in a product that already uses green as its single brand color, a bright green would clash with green used everywhere as a status color. Loop Green is closer to pine or deep forest: confident, a little reserved, more "trustworthy ledger" than "go button."

2. Color System



Token	Hex	Use
Background	#F3F5F1	Page background — a barely-tinted sage paper, not warm cream
Surface	#FFFFFF	Cards, panels, the approval view
Ink	#1B2420	Primary text — near-black with a green undertone, never pure #000
Muted text	#5B6B62	Secondary text, timestamps, evidence lines
Border	#E1E4DC	Hairlines, card outlines — no drop shadows (see Section 6)
Loop Green	#1F5C45	Primary actions, brand mark, "resolved" state, links
Green — hover	#153F30	Hover/active state for anything in Loop Green
Green — tint	#E3EEE7	Subtle backgrounds behind resolved items or the brand mark
Amber — money	#B8863B	Any dollar figure the agent surfaces — always this color, never green
Rust — needs you	#B54A2A	Reserved for "awaiting your decision" emphasis when it must stand out from the green outline pill

3. Typography

Three families, each with one clear, semantic job — not decoration:

- **Headlines** — a serif (Georgia, or Source Serif 4 if available). Reserved for the dashboard's hero line and card titles — it is what makes this feel like a document you can trust, not a chat window.
- **UI & body text** — a plain sans-serif (Inter, or system-ui / Segoe UI as fallback). Everything structural: nav, buttons, labels, descriptions.
- **Evidence & data** — monospace (Consolas / SF Mono). Used only for literal facts pulled from a document — a filename, a date, an amount as extracted data. This is the one deliberate exception to "no monospace for small labels": here it signals verified fact, not decoration.

Role	Size	Weight	Family
Dashboard hero ("N open loops")	28px	Bold	Serif
Card title	16px	Bold	Serif
Section heading	14px	Bold	Sans
Body / description	13px	Regular	Sans
Evidence line	12px	Regular	Mono
Caption / timestamp	11px	Regular	Sans, muted color

4. Layout Model

LOOP is single-user, so it does not need synQdash's client-switcher model. One persistent left nav, one main content pane:

LOOP	Good evening.
	LOOP found 7 open loops.
All	
Money	[Life Event card]
Deadlines	[Life Event card]
Documents	[Life Event card]
Approvals	
Activity	
Settings	

The dashboard opens on the big number ("LOOP found 7 open loops") as the literal hero of the page. This is normally a default treatment to be wary of, but here it is the actual emotional payoff of the product — the number of things quietly handled — so it earns the spot rather than filling it by default. Left-align everything; do not center body content or cards.

5. Logomark and Brand Motif

The wordmark is "LOOP" set in the headline serif, all other chrome in sans. The mark is a single open arc — a circle with a small gap — in Loop Green. It closes into a complete circle wherever something gets resolved: an approved claim, a completed item in the activity timeline, a finished loading state. This is the one motion moment worth spending on (see Section 9) — do not add movement anywhere else.

6. Component Rules

Example — Life Event card



Left border color = category. Status pill outline = Loop Green. Money always gets its own bold amber line.

6.1 Life Event cards

- A colored left border indicates category, not the whole card — amber for money-to-recover, rust for money-to-lose/anomalies, green once resolved. Never fill the whole card in a color.
- No drop shadows. A 1px border (#E1E4DC) is enough definition — shadows are the single most common generic-SaaS tell and LOOP should not have them.
- A dollar amount, when present, is always bold and always amber (#B8863B / #96691F on light backgrounds) — never green, so money never gets confused with "done."
- The evidence line (filename, date) is always monospace and muted — it should read like a citation, not body copy.
- Status pill is an outline, not a fill, in Loop Green — reserve solid green fills for the primary button only.

6.2 Buttons

- Primary (Approve / Review): solid Loop Green fill, white bold text, 6px radius.
- Secondary (Dismiss / Edit): text-only, muted color, no border, no fill — it should look deliberately quieter than the primary action, never a competing outline button.
- Destructive (Reject): text-only in Rust, used only inside the approval view, never on the dashboard card itself.
- Every button label is a verb naming exactly what happens: "Approve claim," not "Submit." "Dismiss," not "Ignore." Whatever the button says, the resulting timeline entry uses the same word.

6.3 Approval view

- Evidence is listed, not summarized into a paragraph — one line per fact, monospace, so the user can see exactly what LOOP is reasoning from.
- The prepared action is shown in full before approval — the actual claim text, not a description of it.
- Approve / Edit / Reject always appear together, in that order, Approve first and visually primary.

6.4 Activity timeline

- Plain chronological list, timestamp in muted mono, entry text in plain sans — written the way a person would narrate it ("Linked this to your headphones receipt"), never the internal step name ("understand_step_complete").

7. Iconography

- Simple single-weight line icons only — no filled/duotone icon sets, no gradient icons.
- No sparkle, magic-wand, or robot-head icons anywhere. LOOP's only "AI" visual signal is the open-loop arc itself — the product should feel competent, not magical.
- Category icons (receipt, bill, calendar) are fine and encouraged next to the type pill — they carry real information about what kind of open loop this is.

8. Copy and Voice Rules

The synQdash rule was never to name competitors. LOOP's equivalent rule is about honesty with money: **never state an outcome as certain when it isn't**. LOOP surfaces possibilities and prepares work; the user and the third party decide the outcome.

- Say "potential recovery" and "may qualify," never "guaranteed refund" or "you will get \$179 back."
- Say "I found a possible issue," never "you have a problem."
- Never use internal system language in front of the user. Translate before it reaches a screen:

Internal term	What the user sees
Life Event	Open loop
Orchestrator agent	(never shown — the product is just "LOOP")
Execute	Approve / Submitted / Done
Detected	New
Awaiting approval	Awaiting review / Needs you

- Active voice always: "LOOP found 7 open loops," not "7 open loops were found."
- No exclamation points. No "Woohoo" / "Nice!" copy on completion — resolution is quiet, not celebratory. A closed loop icon is the reward, not confetti.

9. What to Avoid

- Do not reuse synQdash's dark charcoal + Terracotta palette, or any near-black background with a single bright accent — pick a different combination every time, this one included, for anything built after LOOP.
- No identical rounded cards with uniform grey drop-shadows — the whole point of Section 6 is that category and status are shown through color and structure, not decoration.
- No ALL-CAPS eyebrow labels, no "WORD — fragment" headline chrome, no arrow glyphs appended to buttons or links.
- No confetti, celebratory animation, or gamified badges for completing an open loop — see Section 8.

- No stock "AI" visual cliches — no sparkles, no glowing orbs, no robot mascots.

10. Accessibility and Restraint

- Text on Loop Green and on the background both meet at least 4.5:1 contrast — verify Ink (#1B2420) on Background (#F3F5F1) and white on Loop Green (#1F5C45) before shipping.
- Visible keyboard focus states on every interactive element.
- Respect reduced-motion settings — the loop-closing animation in Section 5 should become an instant state change, not a forced animation, for users who have that preference set.
- One bold moment per screen. The dashboard's bold moment is the hero number. The approval view's bold moment is the prepared action. Do not add a second competing bold element to either.

11. Build Order

Staged, like synQdash — not all three screens at once:

- 1. Dashboard — the hero number and the Life Event cards. This carries the most weight in the demo video; get it right first.
- 2. Approval view — the second most demo-critical screen.
- 3. Activity timeline — simplest of the three; build last, and it is the first thing to cut further if time runs out.